

**UNITED NATIONS**  **NATIONS UNIES**  
**DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS**

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME  
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION  
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT  
2025-2026**

**Fellowship Award Specification**

**United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)  
Hanoi, Viet Nam**

**1. General Information**

|                                       |                           |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <u>Title:</u>                         | UN Fellow                 |
| <u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>    | May 2026 (tbc)            |
| <u>Assignment in the field dates:</u> | May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc) |
| <u>Duty Station:</u>                  | Hanoi, Viet Nam           |
| <u>Sector of assignment:</u>          | Inclusive Growth          |

**2. Supervision**

|                                        |                                   |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>         | Ms Francesca Nardini              |
| <u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>        | Deputy Resident Representative    |
| <u>Name of the Direct Supervisor</u>   | Ms Do Ngoc                        |
| <u>Title of the Direct Supervisor:</u> | Assistant Resident Representative |

**3. Background information**

Globally, UNDP has a mandate to support SDG Integration to ensure faster progress on sustainable development and offers support in four areas, (1) integrated policy and programming solutions, (2) SDG metrics, data and analysis using state-of-the-art tools for modelling and forecasting, (3) knowledge and innovation and (4) SDG Financing options to help countries identify innovative ways to expand public and private contributions to reach the 2030 agenda.

Under the overall guidance of the UNDP Deputy Resident Representative in the country and the direct supervision of the Team Leader of the Inclusive Growth Unit, the Fellow collaborates and supports the implementation of a portfolio of projects, including social protection, ethnic minorities, livelihood development, social impact business development, and policy advocacy that shapes the growth agenda. The fellow will be supporting project delivery, as well as programme development. She/He will work closely with the programme and operations teams in the Country Office, and Regional Bureau of Asia and the Pacific.

Viet Nam has achieved remarkable success in reducing extreme and multidimensional poverty, yet inclusive growth remains a central challenge. While overall inequality has been relatively stable, certain groups — including ethnic minorities, people in remote rural areas, migrants, persons with disabilities, and the elderly — have benefited less from economic progress and remain at risk of marginalization. Reforming the social protection system to expand coverage and ensure better access to basic services is essential to close these gaps. As migration accelerates, ensuring affordable housing and equitable access to urban services will become increasingly important. Although women and girls enjoy equal access to education, progress in other dimensions of gender equality has stalled. UNDP continues to be a leading advocate for inclusive growth, supporting stronger social protection, gender equality, and a more active and creative role for youth in development policy and programming.

Inclusive growth also depends on strong and transparent governance that ensures all citizens can benefit from development. Viet Nam is undertaking major governance reforms to strengthen institutional effectiveness, promote accountability, and enhance citizen participation. Through its long-standing support to national and local institutions, UNDP helps advance these reforms by sharing global experience, building capacity for evidence-based policymaking, and promoting inclusive, transparent, and responsive governance systems that leave no one behind.

At the same time, Viet Nam's commitment at COP26 to achieve net-zero emissions by 2050 marks a historic transformation that must be socially just and economically inclusive. UNDP works with government and partners to ensure that the energy transition creates opportunities rather than inequalities — protecting vulnerable communities, supporting adaptation, and mobilizing sustainable finance for innovation in carbon markets, circular economy models, biodiversity conservation, and the blue economy. In doing so, UNDP helps Viet Nam turn its climate ambition into a powerful driver of inclusion, resilience, and shared prosperity.

#### **4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:**

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, the candidate will perform the following duties:

- Support analytical, coordination and quality assurance tasks under the guidance of the Head of IGU/UNDP CO, contributing to the implementation of UNDP's programmatic work on the SDGs and the 2030 Agenda.
- Facilitate collaboration within the country office and across UNDP, as well as with UN agencies, members of the UN Country Team, and relevant national and international partners in Viet Nam, to support the representational, advocacy, partnership, and communication efforts of the Head of IGU/UNDP CO on SDGs/Agenda 2030.
- Contribute to the integration of sustainable finance approaches—such as climate finance, the Integrated National Financing Framework (INFF), and related policy instruments—across the Inclusive Growth portfolio. This includes supporting analytical work, coordination with government counterparts, and knowledge sharing on innovative financing solutions for inclusive and green growth.
- Support efforts to engage the private sector in achieving the SDGs by helping identify opportunities for impact investment, responsible business practices, and partnerships that

advance inclusive and sustainable development. Contribute to initiatives that leverage private capital for climate action, social inclusion, and the green transition.

Reporting structure and partners:

Under the overall supervision of the DRR and the direct supervision of the Head of Inclusive Growth Unit, the successful candidate will provide support to the portfolio on project management, integration of SDGs in all projects and programmes in the portfolio and provide high-quality portfolio-level analysis which will assist projects and programmes to improve visibility and efficiency. The incumbent will work in close collaboration with other CO teams to ensure that thematic, programme, and project implementation and monitoring are coordinated to ensure coherent and effective delivery by the CO.

## **5. Qualifications and Experience**

### Education

Advanced University in Economics, Social Policy, Public Policy, Development Studies or a related area.

### Work experience

Relevant working experience.

### Languages

Fluency in English. Knowledge of Vietnamese is an extra asset.

### Other skills

Computer skills in word and data spreadsheet, making presentations.

### Competencies

Professionalism: Is conscientious and efficient in meeting commitments, observing deadlines and achieving results

Respect for Diversity: Shows respect for and understanding of diverse points of view and demonstrates this understanding in daily work and decision-making.

Communication: Ask questions to clarify and exhibits interest in having two-way communication.

## **6. Learning Elements**

At the end of the assignment the Fellow will be able to:

- Develop research skills on economic growth issues in Vietnam
- Have a better understanding of topics related to inclusive growth
- Participate in high level conferences that shape the economic growth agenda
- Practice project management and communication advocacy through programme support

## **7. Content and methodology of the supervision**

- Structured guidance provided by the supervisor, especially in the beginning of the assignment;
- Establishment of a work plan, with clear key results within the first two months of the assignment;
- Effective supervision through knowledge sharing and performance/development feedback;
- Participation in Unit/Team/Office and relevant UN SDG and Data for Development working groups meetings to ensure integration and operational effectiveness;

- Guidance and advice in relation to learning and training opportunities within the field of expertise;
- If more than one supervisor; clear agreement of the roles and responsibilities between the relevant parties.

#### **8. Living conditions in the country**

Viet Nam is a peaceful, modernized country. It is ranked among the fastest growing countries in the world. In big cities there is consistent supply of telecommunications, electricity, and water. Essentials such as food and household items are readily available. There are more and more opportunities for leisure, such as fitness, sports, cultural events, restaurants, cinemas. In general, it is safe to live in Hanoi. However, it may be very different from living in your home country, as Viet Nam has its own way of doing things, some of which may cause frustration. If you have an open mind, patience and a sense of awareness, you will be fine.